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News Release

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City of Cadillac Issues Statement Responding to False and Misleading Claims

In response to recent misinformation circulating on social media regarding PFAS contamination, the Local Development Finance Authority (LDFA), and alleged Open Meetings Act violations, the City of Cadillac is issuing the following statement to clarify the record and reaffirm its ongoing commitment to transparency and environmental stewardship.

PFAS and Environmental Responsibility

PFAS contamination is a challenge faced by communities across Michigan. The **City of Cadillac was not the source of any contamination or groundwater pollution**. The contamination originated decades ago from **private industrial activities**, not from City operations or projects.

For more than **30 years**, the **LDFA has worked tirelessly to clean up contamination caused by others**, investing millions of dollars to restore and redevelop affected properties, protect groundwater, and strengthen Cadillac's economic base. The City continues to coordinate with state and federal agencies to identify, monitor, and mitigate PFAS. Cadillac has also **pursued grant funding** to assist with long-term remediation efforts. Like every other Michigan community facing PFAS, this work takes time and persistence — **it cannot be resolved overnight**.

False Accusations and Political Manipulation

Unfortunately, **some individuals have chosen to exploit these environmental challenges for political purposes**, spreading falsehoods and fear to sow division and distrust. These bad actors have made **unfounded allegations**, including **filing criminal complaints** in an attempt to weaponize the legal system against City officials. Those complaints were **thoroughly investigated and rejected**. A **special prosecutor, Sara M. Swanson of Benzie County**, reviewed the matter and, in a letter dated **October 24, 2025**, **declined to issue any criminal charges**. After reviewing the entire file, she determined that the evidence did not support prosecution under the Open Meetings Act.

The City of Cadillac has gone further to ensure full compliance and transparency. Based on a comprehensive internal review:

- **No violations of the Open Meetings Act occurred.**
- **There is no evidence that the LDFA ever met without proper public notice.**

- **There is no evidence that any member of the public was ever denied access to an LDFA meeting.**
- **Every LDFA meeting has been attended by a lawful quorum of its duly appointed and serving members,** satisfying the legal requirements for conducting business under the Open Meetings Act.

The LDFA's meetings have always been open, noticed, and accessible to the public.

Unacceptable Conduct Toward Public Officials

The City also strongly condemns the **vile and threatening comments** that have been directed toward City employees and elected officials, including **threats of violence**. Such behavior is reprehensible and has no place in a civil or democratic community. Cadillac's public servants deserve respect for their work and dedication to the public good.

Commitment to Cadillac's Future

While others seek to divide, the City of Cadillac remains focused on **results, responsibility, and respect**. Over the past three decades, the LDFA and City have turned blighted industrial areas into thriving business districts and neighborhoods — proof that Cadillac is a community capable of progress through collaboration and perseverance. The City will continue to pursue environmental solutions, protect public health, and promote open, respectful civic engagement.

The City of Cadillac remains committed to protecting residents, ensuring safe water, and fostering an informed and respectful civic environment.

The residents of Cadillac deserve facts, not fear — progress, not politics.